cannot support enough livelihoods in the agricultural sector. Both these states have therefore been a part of the Great Indian Migration Wave, latching on to circulatory networks that extend far and wide. How did migration shape poverty and inequality in these regions? Did migration convert rags to riches or did it fail and fuel rages?

One of the principal ways migration alleviates poverty in the source region is through financial remittances, closely linked with the corridors of the Great Indian Migration Wave. Whether sent through postal money orders or electronic media, the remittance market of India is enormous, equivalent to over $20 billion for internal migration and close to $70 billion for international migration.[9] Nearly 40 per cent of the international remittance flows are concentrated in Kerala, Punjab and Goa, which are among the leading remittance-dependent economies of the world.[10] Likewise, domestic remittance dependency was high in Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Rajasthan and Odisha. In 2008, over 60 per cent of the domestic remittance market comprised inter-state transfers and 80 per cent was directed to rural households. Domestic remittances also financed over 30 per cent of household consumption expenditure in remittance-receiving households that comprised nearly 10 per cent of rural India. The empirical evidence on remittances and poverty in India is clear. Remittances reduce poverty and the impact is stronger for international remittances, even after accounting for selection bias.[11]

While source region poverty can be dented through out-migration, an equally important question to ask is if migration improves the condition of the migrants in places they move to, or whether rural poverty is being replaced by urban poverty and the creation of slums. Here, the evidence in India is more conflicted. At one level, the nature of urban poverty is less harsh than that of rural poverty, with less pressures of empty stomachs and greater access to educational and health facilities. One study on urban centres noted that the probability of being poor in India was lower among migrants than the natives, and that migration was a ‘definite instrument of improving economic well-being and escaping from poverty’.[12] On the downside, the health risks of migration have been documented to be quite